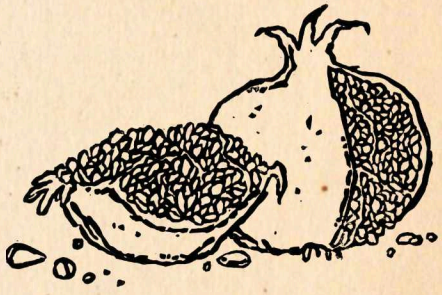
Fruit of Law



By Eli Seitz

With art by Kit Collins

We have wandered and believed as one people, but there comes a time to set down rules that will guide us and keep us safe; stories and lessons from the elders to tell future generations what is important and how to navigate the turbulent waters.

This fruit contains gifts for the future.

Every seed is a commandment waiting to be written.

At the table take turns.

As you put forward your seed or seeds consider the difficulty removing the seeds from the skin, how they are grouped, their plumpness, the density of seeds in your section, and lastly taste them and let fruit inform the rules that you bring to the table.

The Elders construct the rules through conversation reacting to each others' contributions providing laws, testimonies, and decrees that explain or complicate those that have already been established.

Procure one pomegranate.

Convene 4-10 Elders.

Score the outer skin and tear the pomegranate into roughly equal pieces.

One for each Elder.

On your turn put forward a seed or section of seeds to establish a law, testimony, or decree.

A law is a rule that obviously benefits moral society.

A testimony commemorates an event in the history of the people.

A decree is a rule not immediately morally evident.

Inspiration: The Torah and The Stars Recall Our Passage by Sharang Biswas

Game and layout by Eli Seitz at @seitz_eli

See more games at https://eliseitz.itch.io/

Cover illustration by Kit Collins

Learn more at www.kitschcollins.com or @kitschcollins on Instagram.

Long form example

Elder one: “I am not sure where to begin, so I will use this single seed to establish a law against murder. That seems like a safe place to start, by banning murder in our society.”

Elder two: When removing a large grouping of seeds, the seeds pop spilling juice onto the player. “I want to add a testimony that complicates the first Elders law, so I think that there was a battle with a lot of blood spilled. Maybe they were fighting over an oasis or something.”

Elder three: Eats a small group of seeds, but they are bitter with an iron taste. “I will add a decree that whenever we drink water you must add a drop of blood to remember when we violated the law against murder”.

Elders continue adding laws, testimonies, and decrees until the seeds of the fruit have been consumed, for at that point the game is complete. As you wash your hands privately contemplate how the future will interpret your rules and what will change.

The best way to split open a pomegranate is to score the outside peel with a sharp knife, three-quarters of the way through the skin. Then tear the fruit apart with your hands. It should come apart easily without the peel to hold it together. Ideally, you should also make your cut asymmetrical to the natural divisions of the fruit so that each player's section is unique.